MEDIOR FRONTEND DEVELOPER
TECHNICAL TASK

1. OVERVIEW

At PedlDigitl, we build custom WordPress block themes and web applications for our clients. A core part of the role is developing custom Gutenberg blocks from scratch. This task is designed to see how you approach that in practice.

2. THE BRIEF

Build a WordPress plugin that adds a custom Gutenberg block called "Featured Posts Grid".

The block should allow an editor to pick a selection of published posts (up to 6) and display them in a responsive grid on the frontend.

2.1 FEATURES

2.1.1 EDITOR FEATURES

- The user should be able to search for and select which posts to feature.
- A sidebar panel should offer the following settings: number of columns (2 or 3), whether to show the post excerpt, and whether to show the featured image.
- The block should show a live preview that reflects the selected posts and current settings.
- When no posts have been selected yet, the block should show a helpful empty state.

2.1.2 FRONTEND FEATURES

- The selected posts should render in a clean, responsive grid — using the column count chosen in the editor, adapting to 2 columns on tablets and 1 on mobile.
- Each post should display as a card with the title (linked to the post), and optionally the excerpt and featured image based on the editor settings.
- The HTML output should be semantic and properly escaped.

3. CONSTRAINTS

- The block must be built as a standalone plugin (not part of a theme).
- No ACF, Carbon Fields, or third-party block frameworks. We want to see native Gutenberg block development using React.
- No CSS frameworks. Write your own styles.
- The frontend rendering must be handled server-side via PHP, not saved as static HTML in the editor.
- Assume WordPress 6.4+.

4. DELIVERABLES

A ready-to-install zip file of the plugin. We should be able to upload and activate it on a clean WordPress install, add the block to a page, configure it, and see it working on the frontend.

Include a short readme file covering:

- Build/install instructions (if a build step is needed).
- Any decisions or trade-offs you made and why.

5. TIME EXPECTATION

This task should take roughly **2 hours**. We're not looking for pixel-perfection - we want solid fundamentals and thoughtful decisions. If you run short on time, prioritize working functionality over polish and note what you'd improve in your README.